

FIRMS WITH THE BIGGEST JUMP IN RANKINGS

Companies from defence, metals and railways witnessed major gain in their rankings this year

Rank (2023/22)	Company	Change in ranks
221/457	Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders	236
263/479	Lloyds Metals & Energy	216
241/415	Rail Vikas Nigam	174
235/387	The Fertilisers and Chemicals Travancore	152
224/370	Jindal Stainless	146
353/486	Raymond	133
362/487	JBM Auto	125
234/359	Punjab & Sind Bank	125
289/409	Kalyan Jewellers India	120
363/474	The Great Eastern Shipping Co.	111

ONLY COMPANIES THAT WERE PART OF THE BT500 LIST LAST YEAR HAVE BEEN CONSIDERED **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY

NEWLY LISTED FIRMS THAT ENTERED THE BT500 LIST

The BT500 list has seen 10 debutants that were listed this year

Rank	Company	Average m-cap*
79	Mankind Pharma	67,251
253	Five-Star Business Finance	17,741
283	Global Health	15,006
310	NMDC Steel	12,459
313	Piramal Pharma#	12,339
354	Bikaji Foods International	10,208
429	Kaynes Technology India	7,222
433	Archean Chemical Industries	7,049
478	Keystone Realtors	5,973
480	KFin Technologies	5,902

*FIGURES ARE IN ₹ CRORE; #DEMERGED FROM PIRAMAL ENTERPRISES **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY

Tata Chemicals, Tata Motors, Apollo Tyres and Adani Enterprises lowered their absolute debt in FY23.

In terms of the largest quantum of debt (ex-BFSI), RIL tops the charts with a debt of nearly ₹3.14 lakh crore followed by NTPC (₹2.2 lakh crore), Vodafone India (₹2.02 lakh crore), Bharti Airtel (₹1.66 lakh crore), and Indian Oil Corporation (₹1.4 lakh crore).

RIL and Indian Oil Corporation, however, also occupy the top two spots, respectively, in terms of companies with the highest quantum of total income. The total income of RIL and Indian Oil Corporation was pegged at ₹8.91 lakh crore and ₹8.46 lakh crore, respectively, in FY23—both registering strong growth over FY22.

With important metrics being captured in the BT500 study every year, it also provides insights on the companies that are bleeding badly. Not surprisingly, the list of the big-

gest loss-making companies features many new-age digital majors. For instance, One97 Communications—the parent entity of Paytm—registered a net loss of ₹1,777 crore in FY23 though it is lower than the previous fiscal's ₹2,396 crore. Delhivery, Zomato, and PB Fintech (Policybazaar) are also among the top loss-making companies in the BT500 list though the quantum of losses in FY23 has been brought down by each of the digital majors. Besides these companies, old economy firms from the energy, infrastructure and utilities space also feature on the loss-making list.

On an overall basis, however, there are only 30 loss-making companies in the BT500 list that clearly shows that both the study and India Inc. have fundamentally strong and robust companies for investors to choose from. This assumes significance as experts believe that while the stock markets are facing head-

winds, there are plenty of tailwinds as well.

“Emerging market flows will stay iffy and India may continue to see outflows. But [the] medium-term looks very good to us, and after perhaps more than a decade, the US Fed is armed with 550 basis points of loosening capability as inflation cools, and that augurs well for global liquidity, and hence rates and growth,” says Venkataraman, adding that India will benefit from strong positioning geopolitically as well. “All these factors are a positive in total,” he says, adding that the outcome of the forthcoming general elections remains the biggest risk to markets.

Indeed, but for investors looking to invest in companies with strong fundamentals and an equally robust growth potential, the BT500 list is a good place to start. **BT**

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